Goldfish

Looking together,
seeing apart.





01 / PRIVATE EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT COLLAGE



Approval is not understanding.

ORIGIN / AN EXPLORATORY STUDY

My mild colour-vision difference began this project. Six AREALME online-test reports from friends and classmates, completed on one device, suggested that the differences people noticed varied with the colour pair.

These are exploratory observations of colour discrimination. They cannot reveal what another person's private experience feels like.

PROJECT / A NARRATIVE COLOUR-PUZZLE GAME

A painter gathers colours from daily life, paints, then erases and revises in response to others. His colour vision stays stable; confidence in his own judgement begins to change.

THOUGHT EXPERIMENT / CREATIVE HYPOTHESIS

The inverted spectrum separates shared colour names from private experience. Goldfish asks whether similar inner preferences could produce conflicting outward palettes, and whether learning another palette brings understanding.

THE DESIGN QUESTION

If another person's colours win us approval, have we become easier to understand?

First, give it a life.

The prologue begins with a woman's admiration. We then return to the painter's room, giving the image a personal history before asking the player to change it.

01 / CARE



01 / CARE GIVES COLOUR A HISTORY / CONCEPT + PROJECT ART

02 / MAKE



02 / COLOURS ENTER THE PAINTING / PROJECT ART

03 / REMOVE



03 / ERASURE BECOMES PROGRESS / CONCEPT + PROJECT ART

CHAPTER 1 / COLOUR HAS A LIVED SOURCE

Sky blue enters the palette; water restores the tank. Watering the plant brings leaves and flowers; green aquatic growth reveals the red fish. Coffee, photographs and a call to a loved one give other colours a place in the painter's day.

The puzzle establishes attachment before it asks for sacrifice.

FROM SOURCE TO EXPRESSION

Extract, fill and observe connect life to the painting. The player does more than choose attractive swatches: each colour recalls an action and something cared for.

Later criticism can therefore conflict with the player's memory. A plant read as withered was once helped to grow.

CHAPTER 2 / PROGRESS LEAVES A LOSS

Sustained erasing advances the figure while removing the image. Passers-by offer another reading; the agent imposes consequential standards; loved ones express sincere care. These voices are not one shared malice. At the exhibition steps, the red fish remains, carrying earlier care into the finale.

A smaller world.

Same colours. Less certainty.



Chapter 3 / A new basis for choice

Earlier, colour came from the sky, plants, fish and daily events. In the later narrative, comments become new sources. Approval offers a usable direction.

A familiar palette is rejected; a praised alternative turns the painted sky green. Next morning, filling the sky green becomes a condition for beginning.

Yesterday's compromise enters today's routine. A repeated action slowly changes what counts as a sensible choice.

OUTSIDE THE LOOP / DAILY LIFE

REST

GROWTH

SOURCE ART / LIFE RECEDES TO THE MARGINS

Life leaves the frame.

CHAPTERS 3-4 / STUDIO CONCEPT

Chapter 4 / Feedback becomes space

Daily care, relationships and observation recede. The camera closes on the work while comments fill the surroundings.

Making an image, waiting for a response and adjusting again increasingly replace the life that once fed expression.

The painter still distinguishes blue from green. The wrong-colour image expresses hesitation and a loss of trust in feeling, rather than a change in colour vision.

Colour vision stays.

Trust shifts.

THE LAST *goldfish.*

CHAPTER 5 / COLOUR REASSIGNMENT / CONCEPT



A familiar hand. A different choice.

RED / BLUE

GREEN / MAGENTA

YELLOW / VIOLET

BORN / PRESERVED / RECOLOURED

The red fish first appears through care and survives earlier erasure. Finally, it is recoloured. Silence isolates the surrender; applause makes it a public success.

CHAPTER 5 / PRACTISED RULES, A FINAL DESCENT

The full narrative proposes removing prompts after repeated practice. Each fill moves the painter down a step. Chapter 2 exchanged erasure for progress; now filling becomes descent.

The player can complete a familiar gesture before reconsidering its meaning.

EPILOGUE / THE POSITION OF VIEWING

Return to the opening painting, establish the woman as the viewer, then reveal her surrounding world. Her admiration can be sincere even though the painter's experience remains inaccessible.



SOURCE VIEWPOINT STUDY



SOURCE VIEWPOINT STUDY

They stand close together. Their colour experiences remain apart. Approval leaves the central question unresolved.

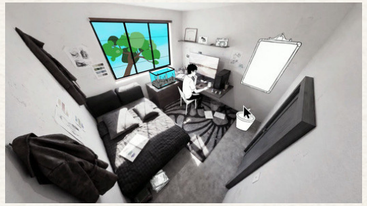
PROJECT ART / TWO EXISTING COLOUR READINGS

A gesture with a system.

The tools remain familiar. The source of authority changes.



A / EXISTING RECORDING / PROTOTYPE EVIDENCE



01 / A SOURCE + THE PALETTE



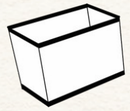
02 / THE PAINTED IMAGE



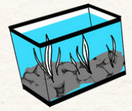
03 / A CHARACTER ON THE PATH

The recording shows the room, palette interaction, painting and an outdoor movement sequence. These frames document the visible prototype; they do not verify every chapter of the complete narrative.

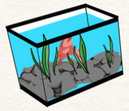
B / ORIGINAL STATE ASSETS / A CONFIGURED RESPONSE



A236 / EMPTY TANK



A249 / WATER / BEFORE



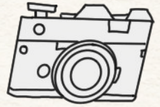
A250 / LIFE / AFTER



A218 / SEED



A340 / GROWTH



A078 / CAMERA / OUTLINE



A079 / CAMERA / FILLED



A228 / DISPLAY



A229 / MEMORY



A246 / DOOR

SELECT → CONFIRM → RESPOND → CONTINUE

01 / DESIGN DECISIONS

Let the player own it first: care gives later loss a history.

Keep the verbs, shift their basis: lived observation gradually gives way to outside approval.

Separate completion from praise: a configured progression condition and an evaluative response need not mean the same thing.

02 / DOCUMENTED FOUNDATION + NARRATIVE SCOPE

Source / receiver events, colour matching, wrong-colour image responses, timed visibility sequences and erasing-linked movement provide a foundation for the narrative.

The complete repetition loop, prompt-free finale and viewpoint transition still need their own corresponding footage or storyboards. Asset availability alone is not proof of implementation.

03 / NEXT QUESTIONS + TEAM

Can players separate a change in trust from a change in colour vision? When does repetition become pressure? Does executing a choice feel like endorsing it?

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Kaiqi Feng / Narrative, art + interaction coordination